

MN ELA CVC Word Analysis Matrix

Comprehensive Reference Grid for Phonetic Transformations, Vowel Substitutions & Decodable Word Families

MN ELA Standard RF.K.3 & RF.1.3

Science of Reading Compliant

Source: Little Lions Literacy Reference



Interactive Digital Grid & Matrix Tool Available Online:

[Access the Interactive CVC Word Analysis Grid & Form \(Little Lions Literacy\)](#)

Filter, search, and dynamically generate student word-sort worksheets directly on the web.

1. MINNESOTA ELA FRAMEWORK & PHONETIC TRANSFORMATION RULES

Core Pedagogical Focus (Phonological Awareness & Blending)

CVC (Consonant-Vowel-Consonant) words form the primary foundation for systematic phonics instruction under Minnesota Academic Standards in English Language Arts. Mastering CVC patterns requires students to isolate phonemes, execute onset-rime blending, and perform targeted sound substitutions across initial, medial, and final positions.

TRANSFORMATION TYPE	PHONETIC OPERATION	SAMPLE MAPPING	INSTRUCTIONAL TARGET
Initial Substitution (Onset Shift)	$/C_1VC/ \rightarrow /C_2VC/$ Vowel & final rime remain constant.	bat → cat → hat	Isolating initial phonemes; establishing rime family recognition.
Medial Substitution (Vowel Shift)	$/CV_1C/ \rightarrow /CV_2C/$ Initial & final consonants fixed.	bat → bed → bit → box → bus	Discriminating short vowel phoneme targets ($/\text{ă}/$, $/\text{ĕ}/$, $/\text{ĭ}/$, $/\text{ŏ}/$, $/\text{ŭ}/$).
Final Substitution (Coda Shift)	$/CVC_1/ \rightarrow /CVC_2/$ Initial consonant & vowel fixed.	cap → can → cat	Strengthening final consonant segmentation and auditory discrimination.
Advanced Transition (CVC to CVCe)	$/CVC/ + e \rightarrow /CV(\text{long})C/$ Silent 'e' modifies vowel quality.	cap → cape bit → bite hop → hope cub → cube	Transitioning from short vowels to long vowel open/magic-e patterns.

2. COMPREHENSIVE SHORT VOWEL WORD LISTS & RIME FAMILIES

Organized according to the **Little Lions Literacy** short vowel framework, grouping essential decodable 3-letter CVC words into predictable word families.

SHORT A — $/\text{ă}/$ (E.G., CAT, MAP, BAG)

-at Family

bat, cat, fat, hat, mat, pat, rat, sat, vat

-an Family*

ban, can, fan, man, pan, ran, tan, van

-ap Family

cap, gap, lap, map, nap, rap, sap, tap, zap

-ag Family

bag, gag, lag, nag, rag, sag, tag, wag, zag

-am / -ab / -ad

-am: dam, ham, jam, ram, yam
-ab: cab, dab, gab, lab, tab
-ad: bad, dad, mad, pad, sad

*Note on -an & -am families: Features nasalized/glued $/\text{a}/$ sound adjustments prior to nasal consonants.

SHORT E — /Ē/ (E.G., BED, HEN, PET)

-ed Family

bed, fed, led, red, wed

-en Family

den, hen, men, pen,
ten, zen

-et Family

bet, get, jet, let, met,
net, pet, set, vet, wet

-eg / -em Family

beg, keg, leg, peg
hem, gem

Instructional Tip

Emphasize crisp articulation of /Ē/ to avoid confusion with short /Ī/ sound in regional dialects.

SHORT I — /Ī/ (E.G., PIG, SIT, PIN)

-it Family

bit, fit, hit, kit, lit, pit, sit,
wit

-in Family

bin, din, fin, kin, pin, sin,
tin, win

-ig Family

big, dig, fig, jig, pig, rig,
wig

-ip Family

dip, hip, lip, nip, rip, sip,
tip, zip

-id / -im / -ix

-id: bid, did, hid, kid, lid, rid
-im: dim, him, rim
-ix: fix, mix, six

SHORT O — /Ō/ (DOG, HOT, MOP)

-ot & -og

-ot: cot, dot, got, hot,
lot, not, pot, rot
-og: bog, dog, fog, hog,
jog, log

-op & -ob

-op: cop, hop, mop,
pop, top
-ob: bob, cob, job, mob,
rob, sob

-ox & -od

box, fox,
pox
cod, nod,
pod, rod

SHORT U — /Ū/ (SUN, BUG, CUP)

-ug & -un Families

-ug: bug, dug, hug, jug, mug,
pug, rug, tug
-un: bun, fun, gun, nun, run,
sun

-ut / -ub / -um / -up

-ut: cut, gut, hut, nut, rut
-ub: cub, hub, rub, sub, tub
-um / -up: gum, hum, sum,
cup, pup, bus

3. SHORT VOWEL SUBSTITUTION & DIAGNOSTIC ASSESSMENT GRID

Use this grid for systematic phoneme mapping during student assessment. Have students read horizontally across vowel shifts to verify vowel discrimination accuracy.

CONSONANT FRAME	SHORT /Ā/	SHORT /Ē/	SHORT /Ī/	SHORT /Ō/	SHORT /Ū/
B - _ - T	bat	bet	bit	bot	but
B - _ - D	bad	bed	bid	bod	bud
P - _ - N	pan	pen	pin	pon*	pun
H - _ - T	hat	het*	hit	hot	hut
M - _ - D / T	mad	met	mid	mop*	mud

*Note: Italics represent non-words/nonsense words frequently used in Science of Reading orthographic mapping evaluations.

4. MINNESOTA BENCHMARK IMPLEMENTATION GUIDELINES

1. Auditory Isolation & Blending (Standard RF.K.2 / RF.1.2)

Before orthographic reading, ensure students can blend 3 isolated phonemes smoothly (/c/ - /ă/ - /t/ → *cat*) without continuous pauses.

2. Word Chains & Minimal Pairs (Phonetic Transformations)

Practice single-letter changes in ladder format: **cat** → **hat** → **hot** → **hit** → **hip** → **hop**. This builds mental flexibility in rapid phoneme decoding.

3. Controlled Decodable Text Integration

Avoid predictable pattern books with unlearned sight words. Pair these CVC word lists directly with controlled CVC decodable readers to solidify automaticity.

Reference Citation & Source: Content compiled in accordance with Minnesota Academic Standards in English Language Arts (ELA) and curriculum structures from *Little Lions Literacy* (<https://littlelionsliteracy.com/cvc-word-list-organized-by-short-vowel/>).